

Finding God's Will for Your Life

Romans 12 Points to a Perfect Will for Each Member of the Body

Romans 12, beginning with the first verse:

I beseech you therefore, brethren...

Of course, brethren, he is talking to you and me. The word "therefore" means, "Based on what I have already said," or, "In conclusion to what I have already said, I am about to say this."

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God...

Now notice this. He called it:

...your reasonable service.

And then:

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind...

Somehow the offering of ourselves as a living sacrifice results in not being conformed to this world. Somehow the offering of our bodies as a living sacrifice results in transformation by the renewing of our mind:

...that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

When the Lord began to quicken this to me, He said, "I want you to go through and do some teaching and reviewing, because I want them to understand how I work in them by My power, how I separate them to what I separate them to, how I call them to be what I call them to be, and how I lead them into what I have called them to be."

What He is saying here is that offering my body as a living sacrifice will somehow result in not being conformed to this world, and God knows that is the last thing I want. Instead, it results in transformation by the renewing of our mind in this area, to prove first the good, then the acceptable, and finally the absolute perfect will of God.

In my early days of ministry, I thought He was specifically talking about the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God only in the sense that I used to believe God sent disease, torment, fear, and all these kinds of things to teach us lessons. We thought it humbled us and broke us. Testings and

trials were from Him, and they were to teach us lessons because we were too stupid to realize God was sending those torments our way, and somehow in His infinite wisdom they were good for us even though we did not know it.

So when they said, "the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God," I thought He was sending disease and things my way to teach me.

Then when I found out He was not sending disease and things my way to teach me, I realized that I had received a transformation of the mind. I did not think the way I used to think. Now I knew not only His good and acceptable will, but His absolute perfect will. His perfect will is not that He sends disease to teach me a lesson, but that He Himself bore my sicknesses and carried my pains, and thank God I do not have to have them.

But by leaving this whole chapter in context, I found out the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God He was talking about was where I fit in a many-faceted body called the body of Christ.

Then this transformation started getting more and more exciting, because it was not just transformation to know what Scripture says about things. It was transformation to prove in my own personal life - me, individual Dave Roberson, singular me - what is His good will, His acceptable will, and if there is one thing I know that I know, that I know, there is an absolute perfect will for my life.

The more peace He brings me into, the more severely I want to seek out and find that perfect will.

I used to think, when I first entered what we call the faith message, that when I began to appropriate things, they would make me happy because they seemed to be a symbol that my faith was working: collecting airplanes and houses and cars and German cars and things like that.

But after getting a taste of this peace at the turn of the year, I can tell you flat out that if I had known how I feel now, as opposed to how I felt then, I would not have spent near as much time using my faith to pursue things. I would have spent time using my faith to pursue the things of the Spirit and the intimate relationship with Jesus Christ that produces peace and joy and contentment, and finally peace, the aggressive weapon.

More faith is beginning to formulate in my spirit than I ever dreamed possible. It is wonderful.

If He said that offering my body as a living sacrifice will result in not being conformed to this world, but in transformation to the degree that I, singular Dave Roberson, can find not only the good will for my life, and not only the acceptable will, but the absolute perfect will, then I want that.

I could stagger through His good will and live that way the rest of my life, even enter heaven with a nominal reward: "Yeah, you did good. Pat, pat, pat." I could enter in acceptable, and He would say, "Well, this is acceptable in My sight," and I would get some honor and be recognized a little bit by the Lamb.

But He said offering my body as a living sacrifice can result in transformation so powerful, such a transforming power in my life, that it can result in the absolute perfect will of God for me.

There is nobody else who will ever live for you. You are unique. You are an individual passing through time. For the millenniums to come, there will never be another person in eternity like you. It seems that one of the devil's greatest snow jobs is to get us so caught up in this world that we do not experience transformation into His absolute perfect will.

To me, this life is now the shortest time of my life. In this last time I was with God, He made the realities of heaven so real that I esteem the heavenly reward as a greater reward than anything this earth has to offer. Buddy, that makes a man strive for the absolute perfect will. You just want to tear hell up here and take as many people home with you as you can.

How many want His absolute perfect will for your life? More than you want to breathe, more than you want to sleep, more than you want to eat? I mean the absolute perfect will for your life.

The Perfect Will Is the Exact Office You Fill in Christ's Body

"Brother Roberson, how do you know He is talking about this?"

Run down for a moment. Look at the fourth verse:

For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:
So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.

Is this chapter not talking about a many-membered body called the body of Christ, of which you and I are individual members in particular? Then he goes on to start listing some of these members and offices, which gets very interesting.

Before we get into any of these listings, think about this again. If the context of this chapter is a many-faceted body called the body of Christ, of which I am an individual member, then I am called to be something as specific in that body as a finger, a hand, a foot, or every other part of my body has a specific calling to my body.

If this is a vast body called the body of Christ, and I am an individual member in particular, then I am just as perfectly called to be a hand, a foot, an ear, or an eye in the body of Christ as any member has been placed on this body.

Again He says the way you can keep from being conformed to this world and be transformed to find not just the good, not just the acceptable, but the perfect operation of the hand in the body, somehow results from offering your body as a living sacrifice.

When I came to understand this, I do not know about you, but my joy was not even complete before. I never even knew what godliness was. I do not think I ever knew what real contentment was until I began to enter this relationship with my Jesus.

If offering my body as a living sacrifice is going to result in more of what I feel now, the question is not whether it is my reasonable service, because He says it is. That is not even the question anymore. The only question I have is how.

How do I offer my body as a living sacrifice?

In the Old Testament, a sacrifice gave itself all the way to death. It is comparative. He wants us to give ourselves all the way to death as far as the world is concerned, yet live. That is what a living sacrifice is: all the way to death as far as the world is concerned.

If you are dead to the world, there is no danger of conformity. How are you going to conform to something you died to?

Not conformity to the world, but transformation. A living sacrifice is somebody who has died all the way to the world and now lives for one reason and one reason alone: transformation by the renewing of the mind. Not only do they understand the perfect will of God for life, but they go about to prove it.

"He has called me to be a miracle-working evangelist."

How do you know? Buddy, just get in the meeting. I can prove it, for I have been equipped.

"He has called me to prove what my ministry is in the area of giving with simplicity and helps. He has called me to funnel millions from the world into the kingdom. If you want me to make proof of the perfect will of God in my life, just go over my check stubs for the last year."

"He has called me to be a teacher."

If I find that perfect will of God, I can prove what is the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God. The power of God will be working in you so powerfully that it will make proof.

Somehow this all results from offering your body as a living sacrifice, dying out to the world, and not being conformed to the world, but transformed by the renewing of your mind to understand, to be able to prove, and to be equipped by the Holy Ghost to fulfill the absolute perfect will of God for your life.

Romans 8 Shows How the Spirit Offers the Body and Mortifies the Wrong Path

We are beginning to understand more and more why Paul says:

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God...

The word "therefore" means, "Based on what I have already said." He is saying, "I am about to say this." So the information on how to offer my body as a living sacrifice, which will end up thoroughly proving the perfect will of God for my life, is in the chapters previous to this one.

Romans 12 was the conclusion. In chapter 12, he was saying, "I beseech you therefore, based on what I have taught you through chapters 8, 9, 10, and 11, go ahead now. Offer your body and let it result in this transformation."

Those of you who have been around the center long enough know that we have taught Romans 8 severely. I wanted you to understand prayer. One thing we learned in Romans 8 approaching Romans 12 is that Romans 8 divides a walk in the Spirit from a walk in the flesh.

He is very clear:

| If ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live.

Somehow the Holy Spirit has to get involved with the offering of my body as a living sacrifice.

Believe me, I know you can be extremely disciplined. You can keep from sinning. In works you can serve God to the tee. You can look as pleasing as the day is long. But if your body is not offered as a living sacrifice through the transformation of the Holy Spirit, then you will not find His perfect will. You will not find anything.

Part of the Holy Spirit's ability to offer your body as a living sacrifice does not just result in you walking away from the things of this world, such as the filthiness of the flesh and the purgings. It also results in mortifying you against anything that would go against your call.

That is why Romans 8:26-27, when talking about this mortification, says this is how the Spirit helps your infirmities, your weaknesses in the flesh:

| Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought...

When you do not know how to pray as you ought, He steps in and begins to make intercession for you with groanings which cannot be uttered. Then it says:

| And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit...

He that searches the heart knows the mind and plan of the Spirit. This is what qualifies Him to make intercession for you according to the will of God. Then:

| And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

It is a many-faceted body called the body of Christ. The Holy Ghost is the One who knows where I fit in that plan. He continually searches my heart and prays that plan up before God in those supernatural languages of tongues.

When He does, He prays the perfect will of God into my life, consequently mortifying me against taking a wrong path, mortifying me against wrong doctrine, until everything that comes against me and against God's plan for my life can be intercepted. Then we know all things work together for good to them that love God and are called according to His purpose.

If the Holy Spirit really is offering my body as a living sacrifice, as Romans 12 says, and it will not result in conformity to the world but transformation by the renewing of my mind to prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will, it is because the Holy Ghost is working the plan of God in my life through praying in tongues and mortifying the flesh. Everything that comes to lead me down the wrong path, and everything doctrinally wrong, the Holy Ghost can arrest and turn, and my life will end up walking down God's purpose path for me.

Praying in Tongues Is Fighting Back by Releasing God's Plan

What do you think you are doing when you come down here and pray in tongues hour after hour after hour? You are offering your body as a living sacrifice.

What do you think edification means? When it builds me up in God, it has to build me down in the flesh.

What do you think you are doing when you speak hour after hour the plan of God for your life into the world of the Spirit with authority and faith? You are literally mortifying yourself against doctrines of men and wrong paths, because the more you pray the plan of God in your life, the harder it will be to take a wrong path. The Holy Ghost goes haywire inside of you.

That is what edification is about. The more you report down here and pray in tongues, the harder it is to take a wrong direction. Why? Because you are perpetuating His desire in your heart. He that searches the heart knows the plan and will of God and can successfully, because He does know the plan and will of God for you, make intercession for you according to the will of God.

The more of that plan you release, the harder it is to walk against that plan in your personal life.

How does the leadership of the Spirit come? When you pray yourself above the confusion.

Many of you have come wanting counseling. "I am in so much turmoil. I am full of care. I am worried. I have my fears." Some of you, I have finally just had to stop you and say, "Look, you cannot hear the voice of God. You cannot be led by the Spirit in the condition you are in."

"I do not know if God wants me to go over here, and I do not know if He wants me to go over there. I am so confused about all of this."

In your condition, the only place He is leading you is out of a walk of confusion and into some peace. To be frank with you, He does not care whether you are working at a hot dog stand or a hamburger shop while He does it.

If you stay in confusion and He leads you out of it and puts you in some victorious place, then the devil will plan next week for you, and it will draw you right back in.

"I do not know what He wants me to do anymore."

Why do you think I kept marching around yelling at you? I let you pray for a while, then I came in and started marching around yelling at you. Some of you are confused, feel hopeless, and do not know what God wants out of your life. You are messed up. The devil comes in and fights the fire out of you. You do not even know how to fight back. Your job is going broke and everything is happening, and you do not know how to fight back.

You walk around trying to confess a little bit of the Word, and hopelessness comes in like a cloud of doom and settles down on you. You want to fight life back. You want to break away from it. Everybody quotes the great verses: "We are complete in Him. You can do all things through Christ Jesus who strengthens you." Everybody yells about it a little bit in church, and when you go home, the gloom cloud settles in again.

You say, "Everything is so big out there. How do I fight it? There seems to be a great big gap between where I am walking and all the victory Jesus said I could have. To be frank with you, I have never closed that gap much."

Are you feeling that way?

I waited for years for God to change people around me and make it easy for me. "Please, my God, do something." He moved, all right. He changed me. He moved, and He changed me.

I started understanding some things:

| There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man...

God is faithful. He will not allow you to be tempted above what you are able, but will, along with the temptation, make a way, a landing pad, for you to escape.

I always looked for the escape: "For God's sake, can't You get all this stuff off of me? Please get me out from under the pressure."

He delights in delivering His children. But do you know what He has to do with most of us? He delivers us out of one mess. We are free for a little while, then the devil comes back, and the same thing that got us into it the first time gets us in again. We say, "God, help me!" and He puts us over here. Here come the circumstances again. "Help me! Help me!" They track you down wherever you are. Have you noticed that?

I do not know why it took me so long to see this, but the deliverance He wanted to work in me was not just getting circumstances off me. I do not think there will ever be a time when I am not in a pressure-filled situation, because if there is not one trying to pull me backward, I will make one because I am trying to charge forward.

"How much do you need?"

"Two hundred thousand by Monday."

"Glory to God, let's go get it."

The pressure is on, but that is better than being dragged backward. If you are going to conquer for the kingdom, when are you going to be without pressure?

Sure, you can hole up, fold your hands, and hitchhike on other believers. That is just what you will do. You will ride into heaven and watch them get their reward.

So you have problems with money. You have problems with women. What is your problem? How do you think He delivers you? By locking you up on some desolate island where there are no women? What kind of deliverance is that? By putting you somewhere where they do not use money?

You can tie a man up in a chair to keep him from sinning. Someone says, "What do you have that man tied up for?"

"Because if I untie him, he will go sin. This way he will make it to heaven."

No, he will not. Just because you have him tied up does not mean he is not sinning. That is what Jesus was trying to get over to us.

So how does He really deliver us from tests common to man? The faster you let Him deliver you from the pressure into peace, joy, contentment, power, and longsuffering, the quicker He can continually deliver you out of natural circumstances. When He delivers you out of them then, you are delivered, because the thing that caused them to come in the first place has been delivered out of you.

Hallelujah.

So when we talk about praying in the Holy Ghost, you people with gloom clouds and hopelessness, saying, "I love God and want to fight the devil, but I do not know how to fight," we have given you a way to fight. That is why I keep telling you that one of the most important things you can do is report for a couple of hours on Monday night and a couple of hours on Thursday night.

Do what? Let God pour through you, praying in tongues with the rest of these people. Most of you are edifying yourself. You are not making intercession. You will know it when we start making intercession. Right now you are edifying yourself. You are speaking the plan of God into existence in your life until the desire grows so strong that the inner witness will infuse itself.

Every time you try to go the wrong direction, it will say, "No."

"All right."

"No."

"All right."

"No."

"You just want me to stand here, don't you?"

"You got it."

It will grow so strong because you have authorized the Holy Spirit to mortify the flesh, to begin to mortify you against anything that would pull you away, by speaking in power the plan of God into your life until it begins to blossom. His desire becomes your desire, and it gets harder and harder to walk the wrong direction.

Eventually, you will get to the place where that Cadillac you have been believing for, that you had to have, does not matter so much. It is funny; when you get to where you do not care, they start coming in.

"I have to have this status symbol."

That is because you are deficient. You are looking for attention from people and things that you have failed to receive from Jesus yet.

When the Lord started dealing with me on these things, it became so wonderful you could just put drab gray on and go sit in a corner because you are complete in Him. You do not need anything from anybody else. You do not need to demand attention from anybody else that you are obviously not getting from Him.

When the peace starts coming from finding the transforming, perfect will of God for your life, it becomes so wonderful that the next thing you look forward to is heaven. You say, "I have already whipped earth. What is heaven like?"

The Measure of Faith Fits the Grace of Your Office

We have given you a direction and a way to fight. I have been hard on you about it because I know that included in your package of edification, you would be working the plan of God. You would be working His perfect will for your life and mortifying yourself against the doctrines of men, and anything else the devil would want to throw at you to lead you off by the flesh and neutralize you somewhere.

You are actually mortifying yourself against those things by releasing the plan of God through your spirit, edifying yourself, praying and speaking divine secrets and mysteries. My friend, you are fighting back. The one fight you should major on right now is releasing enough of that plan of God of the Holy Spirit that His desire becomes so intense in you that it creates the leadership of the Spirit.

When His desire gets stronger and stronger in you, it is hard to take the wrong path.

Let me ask you a question. How many of you have found that your desire to pray more and more has been intensifying? That is because He is working His plan in your life.

All right, let us go a little further:

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind...

Then:

For I say, through the grace given unto me...

This is Paul talking:

...to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly...

According to what?

...according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.
For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:
So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.

Now notice the sixth verse very closely:

Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us...

Gifts, plural, speaking of the many-faceted body called the body of Christ. Gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us:

...whether prophecy, let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith;

Isn't that interesting? I wish we had time to get into that. Let us prophesy according to the proportion of faith. How in the world do you do that?

I always thought prophecy was rather mystical. I thought God just took you over and you went, "Yea, thus saith the Lord." How in the world could you prophesy in proportion to faith?

Whatever you are about to say is in proportion to the faith, or according to the proportion of your faith. So what does proportion to faith have to do with prophecy, and how do you do it in proportion to that faith?

Those are interesting questions. We made prophecy so mystical. If I called you out and said, "Yea, thus saith the Lord," and said something, we would not dare say it was not Him because I said it was.

I always wondered how I could prophesy in the name of God and do it in proportion to faith. Whose faith? It seems to have something to do with the level I am walking in. I thought when God took you over, He could take you to any level.

Anymore, I have gotten so bold about it. When someone says, "Thus saith the Lord," I say, "Oh yeah?"

Paul concludes this thing by saying, concerning any of these gifts, "wait on your ministry." I always wondered how a man was supposed to wait on his ministry. But the way you wait on the ministry is by offering your body as a living sacrifice.

Whether it be prophecy, giving with simplicity, teaching, or anything else, he said, "Wait on your ministry." Now I know how to wait on it. Waiting is offering my body as a living sacrifice, not being conformed to the world, but being transformed by the renewing of my mind to prove the perfect will of God for my life and fill my office.

That is how I wait on Him. Hallelujah. Not just sitting around waiting, but actively offering my body as a living sacrifice through the power of the Holy Spirit. That is the way you wait.

Thank You, Jesus.

Paul says:

For I say, through the grace given unto me...

This measure of faith has always been a major issue with the faith people. If there was any great expounding among us confession people, it usually had something to do with that measure of faith.

God has dealt to every man the measure of faith. I heard much discussion about it, not just from the pulpit, but at dinner with people who are prime in teaching faith. Everybody seemed to have their opinion. Searching in the Spirit all the time, I wanted to know exactly what that measure of faith was that has been dealt to every man.

I know you have it, and you have it, and you have it. I know every person who has ever failed to receive anything from God has it. So I wanted to know from God what the measure of faith is.

I asked those who seemed to be somewhat among them, "I want to understand faith. I have that measure of it. I want to understand it."

Most linked it with the amount of Word a person heard. Well, that is incredible, because I know people who sat and heard Word and heard Word and heard Word, and if you were going to measure the amount of faith they had, they cannot believe for anything.

Then some say, "Well, it is not just the amount you heard. It is the amount you received and produced thirty, sixty, to a hundredfold."

So has every man been delivered the measure of faith? Are you talking about a capacity? Have they been delivered a certain capacity to believe? Or is this a certain measure in us that lays dormant until we activate it, and we all have the same measure? Are we sure whether it is the measure or a measure?

Let us get picky. It really does not make much difference if you cannot make either one work.

But what gives me great assurance is that if He really gave me a measure of faith, which I know He did because He said He did, then this measure of faith must be enough. So whenever I fail, it plagues me with knowing I had what I needed not to fail.

Are you ready for this? This is very deep, so hang on to your spirituality. Listen intently with that inner man now.

The reason He called it a measure of faith is because a measure is part of a whole. At times I frighten myself. I seek out spiritually intellectual people to converse with, and I have proved to some of the finest minds in America that a measure is part of a whole.

I learned that in the third grade. You can take a pie and slice it into three pieces, and each piece will be a measure of one third. When you count the three pieces, it makes three thirds, which makes one whole. My God, the intellect involved in this is beginning to tax me. It is a good thing I am in the Spirit.

For the acid test for those who do not quite understand yet, you can take a pie and slice it once, and you will end up with two measures of one half each. When you add the two measures up, they make two halves, which makes one whole.

Why did he call it the measure? Paul began that verse by saying, "I am going to give you some advice according to the grace that was given unto me. To those who are among you, do not think more highly of yourself than you ought, but think soberly according as God has dealt to every man the measure of faith."

I am supposed to think soberly according to the fact that He delivered me this measure. Whatever it is, I know it is part of a whole.

The advice he is giving us is according to the grace that was given to him. We know what grace is. It is many things, but its most basic fundamental meaning is the unmerited, unearnable favor of God bestowed on you and me.

Grace Gives the Office, and Faith Supplies the Power to Fill It

Let me explain it this way. Have you ever seen a little dog invade a big dog's territory? That big dog jumps on that little dog, and they fight for a minute or two. Pretty soon the little dog knows, "I do not have a chance."

You know what they do? They lie down on their back and bare their throat. They are asking the big dog for mercy. That little dog has no rights. He has nothing to bargain with. The big dog could kill him. There is absolutely nothing keeping him from killing him. But the little dog is asking for mercy.

If the big dog extends mercy, he will take the dog's defeat, concede, and let the little dog get up and leave.

That is how it was with you and me. We were lost in a void, heading for hell, and it looked like nothing could turn it. We had nothing to bargain with. We had no rights to approach the omnipotent, all-powerful, living God. We had nothing to offer Him, no rights, nothing to bargain with.

But He had mercy. He sent Jesus to cross that void. Jesus crossed that void, and though we had nothing to bargain with, He had mercy on us. He gave us an inroad to God. He opened up salvation because of mercy. We had absolutely no rights or inroad to God, but He had mercy on us when He sent Jesus to the cross.

Here is the difference between mercy and grace: grace took you and me, whom mercy had pardoned, exalted us to the King's house, clothed our shoulders with purple robes, placed a diadem in our hand, and called us royalty. He invited us into His house and called us His brother.

It is one thing to catch a thief in your house. You would have a right to cut the thief's hand off. You say, "I am going to have mercy on you. Gather your stuff and get out of my house." That is mercy, because the thief had no rights.

But it is quite another thing to forgive the thief, then adopt him into your family, give him your royal blood, and call him your brother. That, my friends, is the grace of God.

So when Paul says, "I am going to speak to you according to the grace that was given to me, that you ought not think of yourself more highly," he was talking about his call to the apostolic office.

He was saying, "I am going to give you my advice according to the grace given to me. I did not earn my office. I did not merit it. I did not deserve it. I did not call myself to it. But we all have gifts differing, different one from another, according to the grace that was given to us."

I did not earn my office. I did not merit it. I did not deserve it, nor did I call myself. Yet by the grace of God, the unmerited, unearnable favor, He called me and separated me to evangelism, and God only knows what else. As I pursue the perfect will of God by offering my body as a living sacrifice, I will find out what else He has called me to do.

Paul was saying, "You ought not think of yourself more highly than you ought to think."

Why not? Because you did not call yourself. You did not give yourself the office. The same way grace was given to Paul, separating him to an apostolic office, is how you received your office. Then after you got the gift that differs from anybody else, He gave you the measure of faith it takes to fulfill your gift.

It is hard to fail when not only did He give me my evangelist office, but He also gave me the measure of faith it takes to fulfill my office in the body.

All the measures working together in this many-faceted body, every call having received a measure, make one whole, which is a devil-stomping, mountain-moving body of Christ.

He has his measure. I have mine. By grace, God made him what He made him, and then He gave him the measure of faith to fill his office. He separated me to mine and made me what He made me by His call. I did not earn it. I did not merit it. I did not deserve it. So there is no use thinking more highly of myself than I ought to think.

The exploits you are doing are off that measure He gave you to fill your office. You are not so hot. Think soberly.

When I found out I had within me the measure of faith to fill my office, which was given to me by grace, the next thing I wanted to know in context was how to release that measure of faith on the inside of me, resulting in the perfect will of God.

What is the grace I have been delivered for my office? What makes me different from you? Why is your call different from mine?

The next thing I wanted to know from God was how to work that measure of faith.

It goes back to the first part of the chapter: offer your body a living sacrifice. How? Through the power of the Holy Spirit. Be not conformed to this world, but be transformed to prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God, which is the grace He called you for and the measure of faith He gave you to fulfill.

Glory to God.

How do I offer my body? It goes back to the Holy Ghost offering it as I give myself over, walk against my emotions, the world, and everything else, and let the Holy Ghost work the plan of God in me, mortifying me against anything the devil would want to do.

Glory.

So you had better succeed. Every time you talk about succeeding, I look at you and think, "You do not have a right to fail." I have a measure for my office. You have a measure for yours. God specifically gave you a measure of faith to fill your office of grace.

Do you know that measure does not work on anything else? That is why some of you are so miserable. You are not bothering to find the will of God in your life.

"Faith just does not work. I confessed a Cadillac thirty-five times."

I tried to make preachers out of everybody I ran into because I was called. I slept, ate, and drank the call. I tried to make preachers out of everybody.

"Don't you feel called?"

"No."

"How can you live without preaching?"

"Quite simply."

I did not understand. This measure of faith is relentless with me. It is relentless to fulfill my call. I could not understand it. "If you do not feel like preaching, what do you feel like doing?"

"When there is a penny missing off the books, I keep searching and searching until I find that penny. The glory fills the room, and I have a Pentecostal fit."

"My God, finding a penny missing on the books turns you on?"

"Oh yes. The glory of the Lord comes in."

It is like the guy running a business. He prays in the Holy Ghost hour after hour after hour. It does not make him a better preacher, because he is not called to be a preacher. You know what it makes him? The same wisdom and insight available to a preacher becomes available to him in his business and decision-making.

Why? Because he is activating his measure of faith to the full-blown capacity of his office.

Hallelujah.

Praying the Plan Activates the Call and Purges Misuse of Wealth

So what does he do? He runs out and makes millions, and then God mortifies him against the flesh so he can give it to the kingdom. Why else would he make it?

Listen, I am on tour of duty right now. When I get home, you talk about wealth. There will be eons of time to enjoy the wealth and perfection. But right now, everything I can get my hands on, I am reinvesting. Just wait until all that interest comes to full term. It is called heaven.

I feel kind of guilty running around in all of this power to get wealth and not using it to establish the covenant. It is hard for me to wallow in excess when there are children who are not even eating. Something is haywire inside of me if I am going to use your sacrifice for luxury. I am going to live in excess off your sacrifice? That is haywire. There is a wrong spirit involved in that.

You cannot pray in the Holy Ghost very long and stay like that. He will purge it out of you and activate the measure of faith in you for your office, and that is where direction comes.

As it gets stronger and stronger in you, illuminating your office, you will try to go the wrong direction and hear, "No."

You try to make a bad business deal. "I am just getting ready to sign that contract."

"No."

"Good. All right."

That measure is working in you to fill your office, your call, your separation of grace.

That is what you are doing, folks. You are coming in here and working the plan of God. You are establishing your call of grace and activating that specific measure of faith that makes you the hand. By golly, you can be the best hand there ever was in the body of Christ.

How many think you are going to pray a little more than you used to?

When He uses you through edification and begins to purge out the things in your life that have kept you from answering your grace, pretty soon He will bring you to a strong place. Not only will you fill your office, whether it be helps, governments, giving with simplicity, teaching, preaching, evangelism, apostleship, or whatever it is, then He can successfully slide you in to stand in the gap. He can make intercessors out of you.

But first He will bring your life to a place by His power flowing to you that He can flow through you. Part of that will be in your respective call.

I can feel a deep well. There are some things He wants us to know about our offices, our calls, the measure of faith, how it works, and prophesying in proportion according to the faith that was given to you.

We are talking about proportions. We are talking about good, acceptable, and perfect. Wherever you have stopped, you only have faith to operate in that realm. You may be good, but you could have been better. You may be acceptable, but you could have been perfect. Wherever you stop, that is the proportion you will operate in.

A lot of times our lives are so messed up that we cannot hear any direction from God for ourselves, and we run around trying to prophesy direction over other people. Do you think it works like that?

How do you think the devil gets in and breaks prayer meetings up? It is called flesh.

He is looking for people. I mean the kind of looking where His eyes go to and fro, seeking those on whose behalf He may prove Himself strong. Looking for a people He can fill with His perfect will.

Thank God He has given us the Holy Ghost. What seems so incredible to me is that only in the mind of God could He think of this: we become wrapped up in the cares of this life, frustrated from one hopeless situation to another, and to send the Holy Ghost to help our weaknesses and vulnerabilities, only God could think that we are so helpless that we do not even know how to pray.

He even supplied a prayer language. How much does a person want God to do to ensure his success?

He even says, "You do not know what you are called to do yet. You are so confused, but there is Somebody who does, and He is standing by to pray for you." He even supplies the prayer language. He does not merely pray for you; He does your praying through you.

And we think we do not have time. We do not have time to invest into the plan of God for our life.

"I do not have time."

What are you saying no to? You are saying, "I do not have time for the Holy Ghost to work the plan of God for my life."

How are you doing now?

The Enemy's Subtlest Work Is Keeping You Conformed and Busy Until Years Are Gone

I know there is no sadness in heaven, but I happen to know that people look back to the cradle of humanity, Mother Earth. There is not a person who ever arrived there who does not say, "Please, I would have treated my life so much differently. I would have esteemed the top priority to be finding Your perfect will for my life."

A wise man understands these things now, here in the midst of the battle and the heat.

Satan is not who you think he is. You look at religion with starving children. You look at demon-possessed people: screaming, slithering, lower-level residents of insane asylums who cannot even be unshackled because of what they do to themselves. You say, "Here is a picture of the mind of the devil against the image of God, humanity."

You look at devil worship, cults, and human sacrifice, and you think, "This is the devil." If you think that is him, my friend, you do not know who you are fighting.

Let me tell you about him. He is the one who causes conformity to the world. He is the one who brings so many pressures and cares, or pleasures, that one day becomes like the next, one week turns into the next, years turn into generations, until you look back and say, "Who did it to me?"

Now you are looking at the face of the devil.

Sure, it is that person screaming out in agony and possession. Sure, it is cults. But those are where the rubber meets the road. They are obvious. Nobody runs to the obvious. Nobody wants to get possessed like that.

The devil never works in the obvious. The way he works is when you turn around ten years from now and you are the same as you are now. He hid it from you. He hid the revelation that the most worthy cause you could give your life for here is not only finding His perfect will, but fulfilling it.

The devil will keep this hidden from you very well: what you are really looking for can only be found when you esteem the glories of heaven as the greatest reward that can be attained. Only that will bring what you are looking for here.

You are selling out. You are selling your birthright for a bowl of soup. For what? You are too busy for the next twenty years to begin working the plan of God.

What do you think edification is about? Are you going to lay your cards down on the table and trade what little of your life you have left against eternity?

From time without end, people will be running around heaven in their glorified bodies, and the difference of their countenances will be as different as the sun, moon, and stars, which vary one from another. Those who shine as bright as the sun will have a place in heaven that you cannot know exists. You cannot know the feeling. You cannot know the Lamb putting His arms around you, His appreciation and love pouring out over you, as you shine as bright as the sun because He gave His all, and by golly, you gave your all.

What are you going to do, trade the rest of your life for that? It will be great just to enter heaven, but I do not want only that for you.

You come here, and we are going to learn how to fight. We are not going to abandon my brother. Fifteen years ago or so, he got in a motorcycle wreck. We are not going to set him in the service and go from nice teaching to nice teaching and ignore the fact that he is there.

You start acting like God when you bear the infirmities of your brother. You hold your hand up and say, "I know what heaven has to offer, and this is enough."

We are not going to ignore it. We are going to face the issue, and we are going in with him. We are going to fast and pray. We are going to find that line. No more. We are going to change things. We are not going to run off and ignore the issue.

When you meet your crisis, you are going to be glad there is a group of people around like these.

So what if obstacles come? So what if cares and pressures mount against you this week until it is almost unbearable? What are you going to sacrifice? If they keep you from the objective this week, they will work just as well next week.

What do you think pressure is for but control?

The devil hides this so well: if we walk against the pressure and keep producing the plan of God, the pressure will be swallowed in the plan. The obstacles will fall to the objective.

No, we cannot see that because we have our smart devil.

I knew there was some more He wanted to bring. I told you I would catch it.

How many think you are going to pray more than you used to?

Some of you are in a wheelchair of poverty, and He wants to do a miracle on you. He told me, "In these last days, I am going to be bringing them out of the wheelchair of poverty just like I am bringing them out of the wheelchair of affliction."

I said, "Boy, there are a lot of people who will be glad to hear that."

He said, "You wait and see. The guests will all rise up."

They ignored the treasures of the church: the elderly people, the ones who have been put out. We just give them a chair or an elderly meeting. What kind of fellowship do you have? An elderly fellowship, young people's fellowship, and unmarried fellowship, where we get together and talk

over our common problems.

The elderly people have already lived through life. They can tell you what standing is about. God can take those people and turn them into intercessors. Listen, they can change the world. They would be emptying hospitals while we play church.

"Where is that band of believers going?"

"I think they are going down to that rest home to empty out all the sick they can get their hands on. The proportion of faith is working through them because they have gifts of healings, and they have the real thing. They are going down there to get them born again, mess them up, and get a bunch of them healed."

"Where are you going?"

"I have to go to church."

Go ahead. Lock yourself up between four walls and ignore the world.

I am telling you, it starts with prayer because the thing that needs changed is the problem, and the problem is in us. If we can get revival born in us, then by golly, we can bring revival to the land.

Otherwise, you will not care.